

On complete reducibility in characteristic p

V. Balaji, P. Deligne, and A.J. Parameswaran
with an appendix by Zhiwei Yun
in memoriam Vikram Mehta

Abstract

Let G be a reductive group over a field k which is algebraically closed of characteristic $p \neq 0$. We prove a structure theorem for a class of subgroup schemes of G when p is bounded below by the Coxeter number of G . As applications, we derive semi-simplicity results generalizing earlier results of Serre proven in 1998 and also obtain an analogue of Luna's étale slice theorem for suitable bounds on p .

Keywords. Group schemes, saturation, reductive, étale slice, Dynkin height, Coxeter number

2010 Mathematics Subject Classification. 14L15, 14L24

Titre. Complète réductibilité en caractéristique p

Résumé. Soit G un groupe réductif sur un corps k qui est algébriquement clos de caractéristique $p \neq 0$. Nous prouvons un théorème de structure pour une classe de schémas en sous-groupes de G lorsque p est minoré par le nombre de Coxeter de G . En guise d'applications, nous en déduisons des résultats de semi-simplicité qui généralisent des résultats antérieurs de Serre établis en 1998 et nous obtenons également un analogue du théorème de Luna (étales slice) pour des bornes convenables sur p .

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1 Introduction

We work over an algebraically closed field k of characteristic $p > 0$.

In [22], Serre showed that if semi-simple representations V_i of a group Γ are such that $\sum(\dim V_i - 1) < p$, then their tensor product is semi-simple. In [23], he more generally considers the case where Γ is a subgroup of $G(k)$, for G a reductive group, and where Γ is G -cr, meaning that whenever Γ is contained in a parabolic subgroup P , it is already contained in a Levi subgroup of P . For $G = \mathrm{GL}(V)$, this is equivalent to the semi-simplicity of the representations V_i of Γ . For a representation V of G , one can then ask under what conditions does V become semi-simple, when considered as a representation of Γ . In [23, Theorem 6, page 25], Serre shows this is the case when the Dynkin height $\mathrm{ht}_G(V)$ is less than p . For $G = \mathrm{GL}(V)$ and $V = \bigotimes V_i$, one has $\mathrm{ht}_G(V) = \sum(\dim V_i - 1)$.

In [10], the results of [22] were generalized to the case when the V_i are semi-simple representations of a group scheme $\mathcal{G}$. In this paper, we consider the case when $\mathcal{G}$ is a subgroup scheme of a reductive group G and generalize [23] (see 4.8) and [10] (see 2.3). As in [10], we first have to prove a structure theorem (2.3) on doubly saturated (see 2.2) subgroup schemes $\mathcal{G}$ of reductive groups G . The proof makes crucial use of a result of Zhiwei Yun on root systems. The appendix contains the result.

In Section 5, we consider a reductive group acting on an affine variety X and a point x of X whose orbit $G \cdot x$ is closed in X . We prove a schematic analogue of [2, Propositions 7.4, 7.6] under some conditions on the characteristic of k . More precisely, if X embeds in a G -module V of low height, then we obtain, as a consequence of 2.3(2), an analogue of Luna's étale slice theorem (5.1, 5.6). In [2] the language of schemes was not used and as a consequence the orbit $G \cdot x$ had to be assumed "separable". An orbit $G \cdot x$ is separable if and only if the stabilizer G_x is reduced.

2 Saturation and Infinitesimal saturation

2.1

Let G be a reductive algebraic group over k . Our terminology is that of [26]: reductive implies smooth and connected. By an algebraic group we will mean an affine group scheme of finite type over k . Fix a maximal torus T and a Borel subgroup containing T which determines a root system R and a set of positive roots R^+ . Let $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$ be the natural pairing between the characters and co-characters and for each root α , let $\alpha^\vee$ be the corresponding coroot.

If the root system R associated to G is irreducible, the Coxeter number h_G of R and of G , admits the following equivalent descriptions:

1. It is the order of the Coxeter elements of the Weyl group W . This shows that R and the dual root system $R^\vee$ have the same Coxeter number.
2. Let $\tilde{\alpha}$ be the highest root and $\tilde{\alpha} = \sum n_i \alpha_i$ its expression as a linear combination of the simple roots. One has:

$$h_G = 1 + \sum n_i. \quad (1)$$

3. Applying this to the dual root system, one gets $h_G = \langle \rho, \tilde{\alpha}^\vee \rangle + 1$ where ρ is half the sum of positive roots and $\tilde{\alpha}^\vee$ is the highest coroot. Indeed, ρ is also the sum of the fundamental weights ϖ_i and $\langle \varpi_i, \alpha_j^\vee \rangle = \delta_{ij}$.

For a general reductive group G , define the Coxeter number h_G to be the largest among the ones for the irreducible components of R .

It follows from (2) above that if G is a reductive group, U the unipotent radical of a Borel subgroup, and $\mathfrak{u} := \mathrm{Lie}(U)$, the descending central series of $\mathfrak{u}$, defined by $Z^1 \mathfrak{u} = \mathfrak{u}$ and $Z^i \mathfrak{u} =$

$[\mathfrak{u}, Z^{i-1}\mathfrak{u}]$, satisfies

$$Z^{h_G}\mathfrak{u} = 0. \quad (2)$$

For the group U , similarly $Z^{h_G}U = (1)$.

The Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}$ of G is a p -Lie algebra. Let $X \mapsto X^{[p]}$ denote the p -power operation on $\mathfrak{g}$. If $\xi \in \mathfrak{g}$ is nilpotent and if $p \geq h_G$, then $\xi^{[p]} = 0$. To check this, we may assume that ξ is in the Lie algebra $\mathfrak{u}$ of the unipotent radical $U \subset B$ of a Borel subgroup. For each positive root α , let X_α be a basis for the root subspace $\mathfrak{g}_\alpha$. Express ξ as $\sum_{\alpha \in R^+} a_\alpha X_\alpha$. Each X_α is the infinitesimal generator of an additive group. It follows that $X_\alpha^{[p]} = 0$ for each α . Observe that

$$\xi^{[p]} = \sum_{\alpha \in R^+} a_\alpha^p X_\alpha^{[p]} \pmod{Z^p \mathfrak{u}} \quad (3)$$

and $Z^p \mathfrak{u} = 0$, as $p \geq h_G$ (see [16, page 10]).

2.2

Let $\mathfrak{g}_{\text{nilp}}$ (resp. G^u) be the reduced subscheme of $\text{Lie}(G)$ (resp. G) with points the nilpotent (resp. unipotent) elements. Let U be the unipotent radical of a Borel subgroup. For $p \geq h_G$, the Campbell-Hausdorff group law makes sense in characteristic p and turns $\mathfrak{u} := \text{Lie}(U)$ into an algebraic group over k . This is so since $Z^p \mathfrak{u} = 0$. Further, there is a unique isomorphism

$$\exp : (\text{Lie}(U), \cdot) \xrightarrow{\sim} U \quad (4)$$

equivariant for the action of B and whose differential at the origin is the identity. If in addition the simply connected covering of the derived group of G is an étale covering (which is the case for $p > h_G$, and could fail when $p = h_G$ due to the presence of $\text{SL}(p)$ as factors in the covering), then there is a unique G -equivariant isomorphism ([23, Theorem 3, page 21] see Section 6 for details):

$$\exp : \mathfrak{g}_{\text{nilp}} \xrightarrow{\sim} G^u \quad (5)$$

which induces (4) on each unipotent radical of a Borel subgroup. Let $\log : G^u \rightarrow \mathfrak{g}_{\text{nilp}}$ denote its inverse.

For u a unipotent element of $G(k)$, one defines the “ t -power map” $t \mapsto u^t$, from $\mathbb{G}_a$ to G , by

$$t \mapsto \exp(t \log u) : \mathbb{G}_a \rightarrow G. \quad (6)$$

For $G = \text{GL}(V)$ such a map $t \mapsto u^t$ is more generally defined for any u in G such that $u^{[p]} = 1$. It is given by the truncated binomial expression [22, 4.1.1, page 524]:

$$u^t := \sum_{i < p} \binom{t}{i} (u - 1)^i. \quad (7)$$

Similarly, X in $\text{End}(V)$ such that $X^{[p]} = 0$ defines a morphism $t \mapsto \exp(tX)$ from $\mathbb{G}_a$ to $\text{GL}(V)$ given by the truncated exponential series:

$$t \mapsto I + tX + \frac{(tX)^2}{2!} + \cdots + \frac{(tX)^{p-1}}{(p-1)!}. \quad (8)$$

Until the end of §3, we make the following assumptions on the reductive group G .

Assumption 2.1. Let $\tilde{G}$ be the simply connected covering of the derived group G' . We assume that $p \geq h_G$ and that the map $\tilde{G} \rightarrow G'$ is étale.

In particular, by 2.1 and 2.2, the exponential map (5) is defined, every unipotent element in $G(k)$ is of order p , and every nilpotent in $\text{Lie}(G)$ is a p -nilpotent. One can then define the notions of saturation and infinitesimal saturation of subgroup schemes $\mathcal{G} \subset G$ as follows (see Remark 2.17 for the case when $G = \text{PGL}(p)$).

Definition 2.2 ([22, §4], [10, Definition 1.5]).

1. A subgroup scheme $\mathcal{G} \subset G$ is called *saturated* if for every u in $\mathcal{G}(k)$ which is unipotent, the homomorphism $t \mapsto u^t$ (6) from $\mathbb{G}_a$ to G factors through $\mathcal{G}$.
2. A subgroup scheme $\mathcal{G} \subset G$ is called *infinitesimally saturated* if for every nilpotent X in $\text{Lie}(G)$, the morphism $t \mapsto \exp(tX)$ (5) from $\mathbb{G}_a$ to G factors through $\mathcal{G}$.
3. $\mathcal{G}$ is *doubly saturated* if it is saturated and infinitesimally saturated.

An element of $\text{Lie}(\mathcal{G})$ is nilpotent if and only if it is nilpotent as an element of $\text{Lie}(G)$. The reference to the exponential map (5) in (2) therefore makes sense. One way to see that the notions of nilpotence for elements of $\text{Lie}(\mathcal{G})$ and $\text{Lie}(G)$ coincide is to observe that the inclusion of $\text{Lie}(\mathcal{G})$ in $\text{Lie}(G)$ is a morphism of p -Lie algebras and that X is nilpotent if and only if it is killed by an iterated p -power map, i.e. $X^{[p^\ell]} = 0$.

Let $\mathcal{G}^0$ be the identity component of $\mathcal{G}$ and $\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}^0$ the reduced subscheme of $\mathcal{G}^0$.

Theorem 2.3. *Let $\mathcal{G} \subset G$ be a k -subgroup scheme which is infinitesimally saturated. Assume that if $p = h_G$, $\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}^0$ is reductive. Then*

1. *The group $\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}^0$ and its unipotent radical $R_u(\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}^0)$ are normal subgroup schemes of $\mathcal{G}$ and the quotient group scheme $\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}^0/R_u(\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}^0)$ is of multiplicative type.*
2. *If $\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}^0$ is reductive, there exists a central, connected subgroup scheme of multiplicative type $M \subset \mathcal{G}$ such that the morphism $M \times \mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}^0 \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ realizes $\mathcal{G}$ as a quotient of $M \times \mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}^0$.*

We note that since k is assumed to be algebraically closed, a group scheme of multiplicative type is simply a diagonalisable group scheme.

The proof of part (2) of 2.3 will occupy most section 2, until 2.14. Part (1) will be proven in section 3.

By [10, Lemma 2.3], the conclusions of 2.3 hold for $\mathcal{G}$ if and only if they hold for the identity component $\mathcal{G}^\circ$.

Until the end of section 3, we will assume that $\mathcal{G}$ is connected.

Lemma 2.4. *If $\mathcal{G}$ is an infinitesimally saturated subgroup scheme of G , every nilpotent element of $\text{Lie}(\mathcal{G})$ is in $\text{Lie}(\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}})$.*

Proof. As $\mathbb{G}_a$ is reduced, the morphism $t \mapsto \exp(t\xi)$ maps $\mathbb{G}_a$ to $\mathcal{G} \subset \mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}$. Identifying $\text{Lie}(\mathbb{G}_a)$ with a copy of the ground field, the image of 1 in $\text{Lie}(\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}})$ is ξ . $\square$

Part (2) of 2.3 is a corollary of 2.4 and of the following theorem, which does not refer to $\mathcal{G}$ anymore.

Theorem 2.5. *Let G be a connected algebraic group such that*

- (a) *G_{red} is reductive,*
- (b) *any nilpotent element of $\text{Lie}(G)$ is in $\text{Lie}(G_{\text{red}})$.*

Then, the conclusion of 2.3(2) holds. As a consequence, G_{red} is a normal subgroup scheme of G and G/G_{red} is of multiplicative type.

Let T be a maximal torus of G_{red} , and let H be the centralizer of T in G . One has $H \cap G_{\text{red}} = T$. It follows from (b) that any nilpotent element of $\text{Lie}(H)$ is in $\text{Lie}(T)$, hence vanishes. By the following lemma, H is of multiplicative type, and in particular commutative.

Lemma 2.6. *Let H be a connected algebraic group over k . If all the elements of $\text{Lie}(H)$ are semi-simple, then H is of multiplicative type.*

Proof. (See also [11, IV, §3, Lemma 3.7].) $\text{Lie}(H)$ is commutative: Fix x in $\text{Lie}(H)$, and let us show that it is central in $\text{Lie}(H)$. As adx is semi-simple, it suffices to show that if y is in an eigenspace of adx , i.e. $[x, y] = \lambda y$, then x and y commute, i.e. $\lambda = 0$. Let W be the vector subspace of $\text{Lie}(H)$ generated by the $y^{[p^\ell]}$ ($\ell \geq 0$). The $y^{[p^\ell]}$ commute. The map $z \mapsto z^{[p]}$ therefore induces a p -linear map from W to itself, injective by assumption. This implies that W has a basis e_i ($1 \leq i \leq N$) consisting of elements such that $e_i^{[p]} = e_i$, and $(\sum a_i e_i)^{[p]} = \sum a_i^p e_i$. To see this, we view W as an algebraic group. The morphism $W \rightarrow W$ given by $x \mapsto x^{[p]} - x$ is étale. Let K be its kernel. In any basis it is defined by $d = \dim(W)$ equations of degree p , namely: $(x_i^{[p]} - x_i = 0; i = 1, 2, \dots, d$, with (the system of homogeneous equations $(x_i^{[p]}) = 0$ has an étale set of solutions and no solution at ∞ by assumptions). By Bezout, the group of solutions is hence a $(\mathbb{Z}/p)^d$. Let e_i be a basis for it. If the e_i were not linearly independent in W , there would be a linear dependence $\sum a_i e_i = 0$, with the $a_i \in k$ non-zero, involving a minimal number of e_i . We also have $\sum a_i^p e_i = 0$. Hence, by the minimality of the e_i , for some λ and $a_i = \lambda a_i^p$. Rescaling by $\lambda^{p-1} = 1$, we get a contradiction. $\square$

Lemma 2.7. *For $b = (b_i)$ in $k^\mathbb{N}$, define $b^{[p]} := (b_i^p)$. Then, any b in $k^\mathbb{N}$ is a linear combination of the $b^{[p^\ell]}$ for $\ell \geq 1$.*

Proof. The $b^{[p^a]}$ ($a \geq 0$) are linearly dependent. A linear dependence relation can be written

$$\sum_{j \geq m} c_j b^{[p^j]} = 0 \quad (9)$$

with $c_m \neq 0$. Extracting p^m -roots, we get

$$\sum_{j \geq 0} d_j (b^{[p^j]}) = 0 \quad (10)$$

where $d_j = c_{m+j}^{1/p^m}$. In particular, $d_0 \neq 0$, proving the lemma. $\square$

From the lemma above, y is a linear combination of the $y^{[p^\ell]}$ ($\ell > 0$).

End of proof of commutativity: The bracket $[y^{[p^\ell]}, x]$ vanishes for ($\ell > 0$). Indeed, it is $(\text{ady})^{[p^\ell]}(x)$ which vanishes because $[y, [y, x]] = [y, \lambda y] = 0$. It follows that $[y, x]$ vanishes too.

The p -Lie algebra $\text{Lie}(H)$ is commutative and hence its p -power operation $\text{Lie}(H) \rightarrow \text{Lie}(H)$ is injective. It therefore has a basis $e_i = e_i^{[p]}$. The dual of its restricted enveloping algebra is the affine bigebra of the kernel K of the Frobenius morphism $F : H \rightarrow H^{(p)}$, where $H^{(p)}$ is obtained from H by extension of scalars $k \rightarrow k$, $k \mapsto k^p$. It follows that K is a product of α_p 's.

The same holds for $H^{(p)}$, which is obtained from H using an automorphism of k . The same holds for each $H^{(p^\ell)}$ as well.

For any n , the kernel K_n of the iterated Frobenius map $F^n : H \rightarrow H^{(p^n)}$ is an iterated extension of subgroups of the kernel of the Frobenius of the $H^{(p^i)}$, $i < n$. It is hence of multiplicative type, being an iterated extension of connected groups of multiplicative type [?, SGA3, XVII, 7.1.1]

The K_n form an increasing sequence. By the proof of [10, Proposition 1.1], there exists a subgroup of multiplicative type M of H containing all K_n . As H is connected and as M contains all infinitesimal neighbourhoods of the identity element, one has $M = H$.

Whenever a group M of multiplicative type acts on a group K , its action on $\text{Lie}(K)$ defines a weight decomposition:

$$\text{Lie}(K) = \bigoplus_{\beta \in X(M)} \text{Lie}(K)_\beta. \quad (11)$$

If $v \in \text{Lie}(K)_\beta$, then $v^{[p]}$ is in $\text{Lie}(K)_{p\beta}$. Indeed, after any extension of scalars R/k , if m is in $M(R)$,

$$m(v^{[p]}) = (m(v))^{[p]} = (\beta(m)v)^{[p]} = \beta(m)^p v^{[p]}. \quad (12)$$

Lemma 2.8. *Let M be a multiplicative group acting on a group K and let (11) be the weight space decomposition for the corresponding action on $\mathrm{Lie}(K)$. If $\beta \in X(M)$ is not torsion, $\mathrm{Lie}(K)_\beta$ consists of nilpotent elements.*

Proof. Indeed, if β is not torsion, the $p^\ell \beta$ are all distinct and must vanish for $\ell \gg 0$. It follows that the elements of $\mathrm{Lie}(K)_\beta$ are nilpotent. $\square$

Let us apply this to the action of T on G by inner automorphisms.

Lemma 2.9. *If β in $X(T)$ is not zero, the weight spaces $\mathrm{Lie}(G)^\beta$ equals $\mathrm{Lie}(G_{\mathrm{red}})^\beta$.*

Proof. Indeed, $\mathrm{Lie}(G)^\beta$ consists of nilpotent elements. By our assumption 2.5(b), it is contained in $\mathrm{Lie}(G_{\mathrm{red}})$. $\square$

Let B a Borel subgroup of G_{red} containing T , and let U be its unipotent radical.

Lemma 2.10. *Under the assumption of 2.5, H normalizes U .*

Proof. Let C in $X(T) \otimes \mathbb{R}$ be the cone generated by the positive roots relative to B and define

$$C^* := C \cap [0, 1/h]. \quad (13)$$

As in 2.9, we let T act on G by conjugation (t acts by $g \mapsto tgt^{-1}$). This action induces actions on $\mathfrak{g} := \mathrm{Lie}(G)$, the affine algebra A of G , its augmentation ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ (defining the unit element), and the dual $\mathfrak{g}^\vee = \mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2$ of $\mathfrak{g}$. Similarly T acts on U , its Lie algebra $\mathfrak{u}$, its affine algebra A_U and its augmentation ideal $\mathfrak{m}_U$. For the action on affine algebras, $t \in T$ transforms $f(g)$ into $f(t^{-1}gt)$. From these actions, we get $X(T)$ -gradings. By 2.5(b)

$$\mathfrak{u} = \bigoplus_{\beta \in C^*} \mathfrak{g}_\beta. \quad (14)$$

It follows that $\mathfrak{u}^\vee = \mathfrak{m}_U/\mathfrak{m}_U^2$ is the sum of the $(\mathfrak{g}^\vee)_\beta$, for β in the negative $-C^*$ of C^* . For $n > 0$, the weights by which T acts on $\mathfrak{m}_U^n/\mathfrak{m}_U^{n+1}$ are in nC^* . As U is connected, the intersection of the $\mathfrak{m}_U^n$ is 0. The ideal I of A generated by the graded components $\mathfrak{m}_U^\beta$ for $\beta \notin -nC^*$, defines a closed subscheme of G . For any n , the graded component $\mathfrak{m}_U^\beta$ is contained in I , the graded component A_0 of A (the T -invariants) is reduced to the constants. As T is connected it follows that U_1 is connected. As the image of $\mathfrak{m}_U^\beta$ in $\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2$ is $(\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)^\beta$, the image of I in $\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2 = \mathfrak{g}^\vee$ is the orthogonal of $\mathfrak{u} \subset \mathfrak{g}$ and the tangent space at the origin of U_1 is $\mathfrak{u}$.

Claim: The subscheme U_1 of G is a subgroup scheme, i.e. the coproduct $\Delta : A \rightarrow A \otimes A$; $f(g) \mapsto f(gh)$ maps I to $I \otimes A + A \otimes I$. Indeed, Δ respects the gradings; for k the constants, one has $A = k \oplus \mathfrak{m}$, and Δ maps $\mathfrak{m}$ to $(k \otimes \mathfrak{m}) \oplus (\mathfrak{m} \otimes k) \oplus (\mathfrak{m} \otimes \mathfrak{m})$, and hence $\mathfrak{m}_\beta$ maps to

$$(k \otimes \mathfrak{m}_\beta) \oplus (\mathfrak{m}_\beta \otimes k) \oplus \bigoplus_{\beta = \beta' + \beta''} \mathfrak{m}_{\beta'} \otimes \mathfrak{m}_{\beta''}. \quad (15)$$

As $-C^*$ is stable by addition, if $\beta = \beta' + \beta''$ and that β is not in $-C^*$, one of β' or β'' is not in $-C^*$, and the corresponding $\mathfrak{m}_{\beta'}$ or $\mathfrak{m}_{\beta''}$ is contained in I . The claim follows.

To summarize, U_1 is connected, and the inclusion $U \subset U_1$ induces an isomorphism $\mathrm{Lie}(U) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{Lie}(U_1)$. As U is smooth, this implies that $U_1 = U$.

Since H centralizes T , the ideal I is stable by H , meaning that H normalizes U . $\square$

Corollary 2.11. *Under the assumption of 2.5, H normalizes G_{red} .*

Proof. Let B^- be the Borel subgroup of G_{red} containing T and opposite to B , and let U^- be its unipotent radical. As U^- , T and U are normalized by H , the big cell $U^- \cdot T \cdot U \subset G_{\mathrm{red}}$ is stable by the conjugation action of H , and so is its schematic closure G_{red} . $\square$

In what follows, we identify schemes with the corresponding fppf sheaves. A quotient such as G/H represents the quotient of the sheaf of groups G by the subsheaf H : G is a H -torsor over G/H .

Lemma 2.12. *The morphism of schemes*

$$G_{\text{red}}/T \rightarrow G/H \quad (16)$$

is an isomorphism.

Proof. As T is the intersection of G_{red} and H , the morphism (16), as a morphism of fppf sheaves, is injective. Testing on $\text{Spec}(k)$ and $\text{Spec}(k[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^2))$, one sees that it is bijective on points and injective on tangent space at each point. It is hence radicial and unramified. Therefore, on some open set of G_{red}/T , this morphism is an immersion. The G_{red} -homogeneity then shows that it is a closed embedding. As G_{red}/T is smooth and (16) is bijective on k -points, to prove that the closed embedding (16) is an isomorphism, it suffices to prove that at each point it induces an isomorphism of tangent spaces. By homogeneity, it suffices to check this at the origin. The tangent space at the origin of G_{red}/T is $\text{Lie}(G_{\text{red}})/\text{Lie}(T)$.

For the tangent space of G/H we proceed as follows. Let J be the ideal defining H in G and $\bar{\mathfrak{m}}$ be the ideal defining the origin in G/H . As G is a H -torsor on G/H , the pull-back of $\bar{\mathfrak{m}}/\bar{\mathfrak{m}}^2$ to G is J/J^2 , and $\bar{\mathfrak{m}}/\bar{\mathfrak{m}}^2$ is the fiber of J/J^2 at the origin e . By [10, 2.15] applied to T acting on G by conjugation, we have an isomorphism $(J/J^2)_e \xrightarrow{\sim} \bigoplus_{\beta \neq 0} (\mathfrak{m}/\mathfrak{m}^2)^\beta = (\text{Lie}(G_{\text{red}})/\text{Lie}(T))^\vee$. Taking duals, we see that (16) is an isomorphism near the origin, hence everywhere, proving 2.12. $\square$

Corollary 2.13. *Under the assumptions of 2.5, G_{red} is normal in G , and there exists in G a central connected subgroup scheme of multiplicative type M such that the morphism $M \times G_{\text{red}} \rightarrow G$ realizes G as a quotient of $M \times G_{\text{red}}$.*

Proof. By 2.12, the product map $G_{\text{red}} \times H \rightarrow G$ is onto, as a morphism of sheaves. As both G_{red} and H normalize G_{red} , so does G . $\mathcal{G} \subset G$.

To complete the proof of 2.13 (and thereby of 2.5), we follow [10, §2.25]. Let M be the subgroup of H which centralizes G_{red} (as always, in the scheme theoretic sense). By [11, Corollary 2.4(a), page 476], M is also multiplicative. Since G_{red} is reductive, the group scheme $\text{Aut}_T(G_{\text{red}})$ of automorphisms which preserve T is precisely T_{ad} , the image of T in the adjoint group. Hence the conjugation action of H on G_{red} gives the exact sequence:

$$1 \rightarrow M \rightarrow H \rightarrow T_{\text{ad}} \rightarrow 1 \quad (17)$$

surjects onto T_{ad} and T and M generate H . Since M is generated by $M \cap G_{\text{red}}$ and M^0 , and since H and G_{red} generate G we see that M^0 and G_{red} generate G . Moreover, M is central. Thus

$$M^0 \times G_{\text{red}} \rightarrow G \quad (18)$$

is an epimorphism. This concludes the proof of 2.5 and in particular, 2.3(2). $\square$

Lemma 2.14. *Suppose that H is a maximal connected subgroup scheme of multiplicative type of an algebraic group G . Let $Z^0(H)$ be the identity component of the centralizer of H in G and define $U_G := Z^0(H)/H$. Then the sequence:*

$$0 \rightarrow \text{Lie}(H) \rightarrow \text{Lie}(Z^0(H)) \rightarrow \text{Lie}(U_G) \rightarrow 0 \quad (19)$$

associated to the central extension

$$1 \rightarrow H \rightarrow Z^0(H) \rightarrow U_G \rightarrow 1 \quad (20)$$

is exact.

Proof. Left exactness of (19) is clear. The maximality of H implies that U_G is unipotent (see [10, §2.5, page 590]).

Embed H in $\mathbb{G}_m^r$ as a subgroup scheme. The quotient $H'' = \mathbb{G}_m^r/H$ is a torus, being a quotient of one. The central extension (20), by a pushforward, gives a central extension (see SGA3, Exposé XVII, Lemma 6.2.4)

$$1 \rightarrow \mathbb{G}_m^r \rightarrow E \rightarrow U_G \rightarrow 1 \quad (21)$$

and a diagram of groups:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} & & 1 & & 1 & & 1 \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ 1 & \longrightarrow & H & \longrightarrow & Z^0(H) & \longrightarrow & U_G \longrightarrow 1 \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \parallel \\ 1 & \longrightarrow & \mathbb{G}_m^r & \longrightarrow & E & \longrightarrow & U_G \longrightarrow 1 \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ & & H'' & \xlongequal{\quad} & H'' & & 1 \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \\ & & 1 & & 1 & & \end{array} \quad (22)$$

Since H'' is multiplicative every nilpotent in $\text{Lie}(E)$ maps to 0 in $\text{Lie}(H'')$ and hence comes from a nilpotent in $\text{Lie}(Z^0(H))$.

Since $\mathbb{G}_m^r$ is smooth, by [26, SGA3, Exposé VII, Proposition 8.2] the sequence (21) gives an exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \text{Lie}(\mathbb{G}_m^r) \rightarrow \text{Lie}(E) \rightarrow \text{Lie}(U_G) \rightarrow 0. \quad (23)$$

Since U_G is unipotent, any element z in $\text{Lie}(U_G)$ is nilpotent. Let z_0 in $\text{Lie}(E)$ be a lift of z . The Jordan decomposition makes sense for any p -Lie algebra over a perfect field k and uses only the p -power map (see for example [29, Corollary 4.5.9, page 135]). Thus, by using the Jordan decomposition of the lift z_0 in $\text{Lie}(E)$ and noting that the semi-simple part gets mapped to zero in $\text{Lie}(U_G)$, we can assume that z_0 can also be chosen to be nilpotent.

Since every nilpotent in $\text{Lie}(E)$ comes from a nilpotent in $\text{Lie}(Z^0(H))$, we conclude that z gets lifted to a nilpotent in $\text{Lie}(Z^0(H))$. This implies that (19) is also right exact. $\square$

Lemma 2.15. *Suppose that $\mathcal{G}$ is a subgroup scheme of G which is infinitesimally saturated in G . Then the subgroup scheme $Z_{\mathcal{G}}^0(H)$ is infinitesimally saturated in G ; in particular, every non-zero nilpotent in $\text{Lie}(Z_{\mathcal{G}}^0(H))$ lies in $\text{Lie}(Z_{\mathcal{G}}^0(H)_{\text{red}})$.*

Proof. If ξ in $\text{Lie}(Z_{\mathcal{G}}^0(H))$ is nilpotent, the map $\varphi : t \mapsto \exp(t\xi) : \mathbb{G}_a \rightarrow G$ factors through $\mathcal{G}$. Since H is central in $Z_{\mathcal{G}}^0(H)$, the action of H by inner automorphisms fixes ξ . Since the map “exp” is compatible with conjugation the entire curve φ is fixed by H . Therefore, φ factors through $Z_G(H)$ and hence through $Z_{\mathcal{G}}^0(H)_{\text{red}}$, since $\mathbb{G}_a$ is reduced and connected, and hence $\xi \in \text{Lie}(Z_{\mathcal{G}}^0(H)_{\text{red}})$. This completes the proof of the lemma. $\square$

We have the following extension of [10, Lemma 2.7, Corollary 2.11].

Lemma 2.16. *Let $\mathcal{G}$ be as in 2.15. Let $H \subset \mathcal{G}$ be a maximal connected subgroup scheme of multiplicative type. Then the central extension (20) splits and $U_{\mathcal{G}}$ is a smooth unipotent group.*

Proof. We claim that $U_{\mathcal{G}}$ is smooth. By Lemma 2.14, every element z in $\text{Lie}(U_{\mathcal{G}})$ comes from a nilpotent ξ in $\text{Lie}(Z_{\mathcal{G}}^0(H))$. By 2.15, ξ is in $\text{Lie}(Z_{\mathcal{G}}^0(H)_{\text{red}})$. Its image z is hence in $\text{Lie}(U_{\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}})$. Thus, $\text{Lie}(U_{\mathcal{G}}) = \text{Lie}(U_{\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}})$ proving the claim.

Now we have a central extension (20) with the added feature that $U_{\mathcal{G}}$ is smooth. By [26, SGA3, Exposé XVII, Theorem 6.1.1] it follows that (20) splits (uniquely) and

$$Z_{\mathcal{G}}^0(H) = H \times U_{\mathcal{G}}. \quad (24)$$

□

Remark 2.17. Recall that in 2.2, for the existence of an exponential map (5) we assumed that the covering morphism $\tilde{G} \rightarrow G'$ is étale, which therefore became a part of the standing assumption (2.1). The case which gets excluded is when the simply connected cover of the derived group has factors of $\mathrm{SL}(p)$. For instance, when G' is simple with $p = h_G$, the only case excluded is $G' = \mathrm{PGL}(p)$.

Let G be a reductive group for which $p = h_G$. The tables of Coxeter numbers of simple groups show that except for type A , where $h_{\mathrm{SL}(n)} = n$, Coxeter numbers are even greater than 2. It follows that G is a product of $\mathrm{SL}(p)$'s and other simple factors with p larger than their Coxeter numbers.

Even when the morphism $\tilde{G} \rightarrow G'$ is not étale, we can still define the notions of saturation (resp infinitesimal saturation) of subgroup schemes $\mathcal{G} \subset G$ as follows.

Say $\mathcal{G} \subset G$ is saturated (resp infinitesimally saturated) if the inverse image of $\mathcal{G}$ in $\tilde{G}$ is saturated (resp infinitesimally saturated). With this definition, Theorem 2.3 remains true for $p \geq h_G$.

This notion of saturation (resp infinitesimal saturation) can also be seen in terms of suitably defined t -power maps and exponential maps. We restrict ourselves to the case when $G' = \mathrm{PGL}(p)$.

At the level of Lie algebras, the induced morphism:

$$\mathfrak{sl}(p) \rightarrow \mathfrak{pgl}(p) \quad (25)$$

is a radicial map on the locus of nilpotent elements. If $A \in \mathfrak{gl}(p)$ is a matrix representing an element of $\mathfrak{pgl}(p)$, it is nilpotent if all but the constant coefficients of the characteristic polynomial vanishes, i.e. $\mathrm{Tr}(\wedge^i(A)) = 0$ for $i < p$ and the characteristic polynomial reduces to $T^p - \det(A)$. This condition is stable under $A \mapsto A + \lambda \cdot I$ as $(T - \lambda)^p - \det(A + \lambda \cdot I) = T^p - (\det(A) + \lambda^p) = T^p - \det(A)^{1/p} \cdot I$.

We get the unique lift $\tilde{A} \in \mathfrak{sl}(p)$ by taking $\tilde{A} := A - \det(A)^{1/p} \cdot I$. Now one has $\mathrm{Tr}(\wedge^i(\tilde{A})) = 0$ for $1 \leq i \leq p$ and hence we can define the exponential morphism $\mathbb{G}_a \rightarrow \mathrm{PGL}(p)$ as:

$$t \mapsto \exp(tA) := \exp(t\tilde{A}). \quad (26)$$

Likewise, in the case of unipotents in the group $\mathrm{PGL}(p)$, the restriction of this map to the locus of unipotent elements:

$$\mathrm{SL}(p)^u \rightarrow \mathrm{PGL}(p)^u \quad (27)$$

is radicial. Thus, any unipotent $u \in \mathrm{PGL}(p)$ has a unique unipotent lift $\tilde{u} \in \mathrm{SL}(p)$ and one can define the t -power map $\mathbb{G}_a \rightarrow \mathrm{PGL}(p)$ as:

$$u^t := \mathrm{image}(\tilde{u}^t). \quad (28)$$

With the notions of t -power map and exponential morphisms in place, we can define the notions of saturation (resp infinitesimal saturation) of subgroup schemes $\mathcal{G} \subset G'$ exactly as in Definition 2.2 using (28) (resp (26)) and these coincide with the definitions made above.

We note however that these “punctual” maps, i.e. defined for each nilpotent A (resp each unipotent u), are not induced by a morphism from $\mathfrak{pgl}(p)_{\mathrm{nilp}}$ to $\mathrm{PGL}(p)^u$ (resp. $\mathbb{G}_a \times \mathrm{PGL}(p)^u \rightarrow \mathrm{PGL}(p)^u$: $(t, u) \mapsto u^t$ is not a morphism).

3 Completion of proof of the structure theorem 2.3

We begin by stating a general result on root systems whose proof is given in the appendix.

Proposition 3.1. *Let R be an irreducible root system with Coxeter number h and let X be the lattice spanned by R . Let $\varphi : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ be a homomorphism. Then there exists a basis B for R such that if $\alpha \in R$ satisfies $\varphi(\alpha) \in [0, 1/h) \bmod \mathbb{Z}$, then α is positive with respect to B .*

3.1

Assumption 2.1 on the reductive group G continues to be in force. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a subgroup scheme of G , and H a maximal connected subgroup scheme of multiplicative type of $\mathcal{G}$. For the existence of H see [10, Proposition 2.1].

Let $X(H)$ be the group of characters of H . The action of H on $\mathrm{Lie}(G)$ by conjugation gives an $X(H)$ -gradation $\mathrm{Lie}(G) = \mathrm{Lie}(Z_G^0(H)) \oplus \bigoplus_{\alpha \neq 0} \mathrm{Lie}(G)^\alpha$. Recall that if M is a connected group scheme of multiplicative type over k , the group of characters $X(M)$ is finitely generated and does not have torsion prime to p . As k is algebraically closed, this means that M is a product of subgroups isomorphic to $\mathbb{G}_m$ or μ_{p^j} with $j > 0$.

Corollary 3.2 (cf. [10, Lemma 2.12]). *Let M be a connected subgroup scheme of multiplicative type of G and suppose that $p > h_G$. The action of M on $\mathrm{Lie}(G)$ by conjugation gives an $X(M)$ -gradation $\mathrm{Lie}(G) = \bigoplus_{\alpha \in X(M)} \mathrm{Lie}(G)^\alpha$. If $\alpha \neq 0$, then for $\xi \in \mathrm{Lie}(G)^\alpha$ one has $\xi^{[p]} = 0$. In particular, if $M = H$ and $\xi \in \mathrm{Lie}(G)^\alpha$ we have $\xi^{[p]} = 0$.*

Proof. If α is of infinite order, it suffices to apply 2.8. If α is of finite order, there is a subgroup N of M isomorphic to μ_{p^j} to which α restricts non-trivially and it suffices to prove 3.2 for N and the restriction of α to N . Let us choose an isomorphism of $X(N)$ with $X(\mu_{p^j}) = \mathbb{Z}/p^j$ such that the image of α in $\mathbb{Z}/p^j$ is of the form p^b with $0 \leq b < j$.

In a smooth algebraic group, the maximal connected subgroups of multiplicative type are (maximal) tori. Indeed, if T is such a maximal subgroup, its centralizer $Z_G(T)$ is smooth, being the fixed locus of a linearly reductive group acting on a smooth variety (see for example [11, Theorem 2.8, Chapter II, §5]). Define $U := Z_G(T)^\circ/T$. The group scheme U is smooth, as a quotient of $Z_G(T)^\circ$ which is smooth, and is unipotent by maximality of T . By [26, SGA3, Exposé XVII, Theorem 6.1.1], we have a splitting $Z_G(T)^\circ \simeq T \times U$, and hence T is smooth.

In our case N is hence contained in a maximal torus T of G . Let

$$\varphi : X(T) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z} \tag{29}$$

be the composite of $X(T) \rightarrow X(N) = \mathbb{Z}/p^j$ and of the inclusion $x \mapsto x/p^j$ of $\mathbb{Z}/p^j$ in $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$.

The N -weight space $\mathrm{Lie}(G)^\alpha$ is the sum of T -weight spaces $\mathrm{Lie}(G)^\beta$ for β a root such that $\varphi(\beta) = 1/p^{j-b}$. As $0 < 1/p^{j-b} \leq 1/p < 1/h$ we may apply 3.1, to conclude that $\mathrm{Lie}(G)^\alpha$ is contained in the Lie algebra of the unipotent radical of a Borel subgroup of G . In particular, it consists of nilpotent elements, proving 3.2. $\square$

3.2

The proof of 2.3 now follows [10, pages 594–599] verbatim with a sole alteration; recall that in [10] the group G was the linear group $\mathrm{GL}(V)$ and the condition on the characteristic was $p > \dim(V)$. For an arbitrary connected reductive G , this condition now gets replaced by $p > h_G$, which makes 3.2 applicable.

Remark 3.3. If $G_i = \mathrm{GL}(V_i)$ one has $h_{G_i} = \dim(V_i)$. In the case $G = \prod \mathrm{GL}(V_i)$ with for each i , $p > \dim(V_i)$, the case $p > h_G$ of Theorem 2.3 gives us [10, Theorem 1.7].

Example 3.4 ((Brian Conrad)). Here is an example in any characteristic $p > 0$, of a connected group of multiplicative type M acting on a reductive group G , and of a non-trivial character α of M , such that the weight space $\text{Lie}(G)^\alpha$ contains elements which are not nilpotent. We take $G = \text{SL}_p$ (so that $h_G = p$) and $M = \mu_{p^2}$, and for α the character $\zeta \mapsto \zeta^{[p]}$.

We embed M into the maximal torus of diagonal matrices of SL_p by

$$\zeta \mapsto \text{diag}(\zeta^0, \zeta^{-p}, \zeta^{-2p}, \dots, \zeta^{-(p-1)p}).$$

The restriction to M of each simple root and of the lowest root is the character $\alpha : \zeta \mapsto \zeta^{[p]}$, and $\text{Lie}(G)^\alpha$ is the sum of the corresponding root spaces. In the standard visualization of SL_p this weight space inside $\text{Lie}(G) = \mathfrak{sl}_p$ is the span of the super-diagonal entries and the lower-left entry.

A sum of non-zero elements in those root lines contributing to $\text{Lie}(G)^\alpha$ is a $p \times p$ matrix $X \in \mathfrak{sl}_p$ which satisfies

$$X(e_1) = t_p e_p, \quad X(e_2) = t_1 e_1, \quad \dots, \quad X(e_p) = t_{p-1} e_{p-1}. \quad (30)$$

Iterating p times gives $X^p = \text{diag}(t, \dots, t)$, with $t := \prod t_j \neq 0$. Hence, $X \in \text{Lie}(G)^\alpha$ is not nilpotent.

Example 3.5. A variant of the above example leads to an example of an infinitesimally saturated group scheme $\mathcal{G} \subset \text{SL}(V)$ with $\dim(V) = p$ and such that V is an irreducible representation and $\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}$ is a unipotent group. This in particular implies that $\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}$ is not normal in $\mathcal{G}$.

Let V be the affine algebra of μ_p , that is

$$V = \mathcal{O}(\mu_p) := \frac{k[u]}{(u^{[p]} - 1)}. \quad (31)$$

The vector space V admits the basis $\{u^i \mid i \in \mathbb{Z}/p\}$.

The multiplicative group $\mathcal{O}(\mu_p)^*$ acts by multiplication on V . For $f \in \mathcal{O}(\mu_p)^*$, $f^{[p]}$ is constant. Define N_f to be the constant value of $f^{[p]}$. It is in fact the norm of f . The action of $\mathcal{O}(\mu_p)^*$ on V induces an action of the subgroup $N := \{f \in \mathcal{O}(\mu_p)^* \mid N_f = 1\}$.

On V we have also the action of $\mathbb{Z}/p$ by translations and this action normalizes the group $\mathcal{O}(\mu_p)^*$ and its subgroup N . Consider the group scheme:

$$\mathcal{G} := (\mathbb{Z}/p) \ltimes N. \quad (32)$$

We make a few observations on $\mathcal{G}$:

1. The group $\mathcal{G}$ is infinitesimally saturated.
2. In $\mathcal{G}$ consider the first factor $\mathbb{Z}/p$ and u_i , $i \in \mathbb{Z}/p$. These subgroups generate a subgroup H , which is a central extension of $\mathbb{Z}/p$ by $\mathbb{Z}/p$ by $\mathbb{Z}/p$.
3. The representation V is irreducible as an H -module. Indeed, a $\mathbb{Z}/p$ -submodule is generated by some of the u_i , and if non-zero and $\mathbb{Z}/p$ -stable, contains all of them. A fortiori, V is an irreducible $\mathcal{G}$ -module.
4. The reduced group $\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}$ can be identified with the unipotent group $\{f \in \mathcal{O}(\mu_p)^* \mid f(1) = 1\}$.
5. The subgroup $\mathcal{G}_{\text{red}}$ is not normal as the point 1 of $\mathbb{Z}/p$ is not invariant by translations.

4 Semi-simplicity statements

Let G be a reductive group. Let C be an algebraic group and $\rho : C \rightarrow G$ be a morphism.

Definition 4.1 ([23, page 20]). One says that ρ is *cr* if, whenever ρ factorsthrough a parabolic P of G , it factors through a Levi subgroup of P .

When $G = \mathrm{GL}(V)$, ρ is *cr* if and only if the representation V of C is completely reducible (or equivalently, semi-simple) and hence the terminology.

The property of ρ being *cr* depends only on the subgroup scheme of G which is the (schematic) image of C . It in fact only depends on the image of C in the adjoint group G_{ad} .

Indeed, the parabolic subgroups of G are the inverse images of the parabolic subgroups of G_{ad} , and similarly for the Levi subgroups. A subgroup scheme $\mathcal{G}$ of G will be called *cr* if its inclusion in G is so.

For an irreducible root system R , let $\tilde{\alpha} = \sum n_i \alpha_i$ be the highest root and its expression as a linear combination of the simple roots. The characteristic p of k is called *good* for R if p is larger than each n_i . For a general root system R , p is good if it is so for each irreducible component of R .

Proposition 4.2. *Suppose C is an extension*

$$1 \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A \rightarrow 1 \quad (33)$$

*with A° of multiplicative type and $A = A^\circ$ a finite group of order prime to p , and suppose that p is good. Let $\rho : C \rightarrow G$ be a morphism. If the restriction of ρ to B is *cr*, then ρ is *cr*.*

We don't know whether the proposition holds without the assumption that p is good.

Proof. Let P be a parabolic subgroup, U its unipotent radical, and $\mathfrak{u}$ the Lie algebra of U . The parabolic P is said to be *restricted* if the nilpotence class of U is less than p . If P is a maximal parabolic corresponding to a simple root α , the nilpotence class of U is the coefficient of α in the highest root. It follows that p is good if and only if all the maximal parabolic subgroups are restricted.

By [21, Proposition 5.3] (credited by the author to Serre, see ??), if P is restricted, one obtains by specialization from characteristic 0, a P -equivariant isomorphism:

$$\exp : (\mathfrak{u}, \cdot) \xrightarrow{\sim} U \quad (34)$$

from $\mathfrak{u}$ endowed with the Campbell-Hausdorff group law, to U .

We will first show that whenever ρ factors through a restricted parabolic subgroup P as above, if the restriction of ρ to B factors through some Levi subgroup of P , then ρ itself factors through some Levi subgroup of P .

The group $U(k)$ acts on the right on the set $\mathcal{L}(k)$ of Levi subgroups of P by

$$u \in U(k) \text{ acts by } L \mapsto \nu^{-1} L \nu.$$

This action turns $\mathcal{L}(k)$ into a $U(k)$ -torsor. This expresses the fact that two Levi subgroups are conjugate by a unique element of $U(k)$. The group $P(k)$ acts on $\mathcal{L}(k)$ and on $U(k)$ by conjugation. This turns $\mathcal{L}(k)$ into an equivariant $U(k)$ -torsor.

We will need a scheme-theoretic version of the above. Fix a Levi subgroup L_o . Let $\mathcal{L}$ be the trivial U -torsor (i.e. U with the right action of U by right translations). We have the family of Levi subgroups $L_u := u^{-1} L_o u$ parametrized by $\mathcal{L} = U$. We let P act on U by conjugation, and on $\mathcal{L}$ as follows: $p = v\ell$ in $P = U \rtimes L$ acts on $\mathcal{L} = U$ by $u \mapsto v^{-1} \ell u \ell^{-1} v$. This turns $\mathcal{L}$ into an equivariant U -torsor. When we pass to k -points, and attach to u in $\mathcal{L}$ the Levi subgroup $u L_o u^{-1}$, we recover the previously described situation.

The morphism $\rho : C \rightarrow P$ turns $\mathcal{L}$ into an equivariant U -torsor. A point x of $\mathcal{L}$ corresponding to a Levi subgroup L_x is fixed by C (scheme-theoretically) if and only if ρ factors through L_x . This expresses the fact that a Levi subgroup is its own normalizer in P .

Let U_B be the subgroup of U fixed by B , for the conjugation action. If B has a fixed point in $\mathcal{L}$, the fixed locus $\mathcal{L}^B$ is a U_B -torsor. As B is a normal subgroup of C , C acts on $\mathcal{L}^B$ and U_B , and the action factors through A .

The isomorphism $\exp : (\mathfrak{u}_B, \cdot) \xrightarrow{\sim} U_B$ is compatible with the action of B by conjugation. Hence it induces an isomorphism from $(\mathfrak{u}_B)$ to U_B . Let $Z^i(\mathfrak{u}_B)$ be the central series of $\mathfrak{u}_B$ and define $Z^i(U_B) := \exp(Z^i(\mathfrak{u}_B))$. The isomorphism $\exp$ induces an isomorphism between the vector group $\mathrm{Gr}_i(\mathfrak{u}_B)$ and $Z^i(U_B)/Z^{i+1}(U_B)$, compatible with the action of A . On $\mathrm{Gr}_i(\mathfrak{u}_B)$, this action is linear.

The assumption on A amounts to saying that A is linearly reductive, that is, all its representations are semi-simple. Equivalently, if k is the trivial representation, any extension

$$0 \rightarrow V \rightarrow E \rightarrow k \rightarrow 0 \quad (35)$$

splits. Passing from E to $b^{-1}(1)$, such extensions correspond to A -equivariant V -torsors, and the extension splits if and only if A has a scheme-theoretic fixed point on the corresponding torsor.

Define $U_{B,i}$ to be $U_B/Z^i(U_B)$, and $\mathcal{L}_{B,i}$ to be the $U_{B,i}$ -torsor obtained from $\mathcal{L}$ by pushing by $U_B \rightarrow U_{B,i}$. We prove by induction on i that A has a fixed point on $\mathcal{L}_{B,i}$.

As $U_B \rightarrow U_{B,1}$ is trivial, the case $i = 1$ is trivial. If x is a fixed point of A in $\mathcal{L}_{B,i}$, the inverse image of x in $\mathcal{L}_{B,i+1}$ is an equivariant A -torsor on $\mathrm{Gr}_i(\mathfrak{u}_B) \simeq Z^i(U_B)/Z^{i+1}(U_B)$. By linear reductivity, A has a fixed point on the inverse image.

As the central descending series of $\mathfrak{u}$, and hence of $\mathfrak{u}_B$ terminates, this proves 4.2 for restricted parabolic subgroups.

We now prove 4.2 by induction on (the dimension) of G . Suppose that ρ factors through a proper parabolic subgroup P . As p is good, there exists a restricted proper parabolic Q containing P , and P is the inverse image by the projection $Q \rightarrow Q/R_u(Q)$ of a parabolic P' of $Q/R_u(Q)$. Let L be a Levi subgroup of Q through which ρ factors and let P_L be the parabolic subgroup of L obtained as the inverse image of P' by the isomorphism $L \xrightarrow{\sim} Q/R_u(Q)$. Levi subgroups of P_L are Levi subgroups of P , and it remains to apply the induction hypothesis to L , for which p is good too. $\square$

Remark 4.3. For several results related to 4.2 but in the setting of reduced subgroups, see [3, Theorem 3.10] and [4, Theorem 1.1 and Corollary 3.7].

Fix in the reductive group G , a maximal torus T , and a system of simple roots corresponding to a Borel subgroup B containing T . Let U be the unipotent radical of B .

Definition 4.4 ((cf. [12], [22], [14])). The *Dynkin height* $\mathrm{ht}_G(V)$ of a representation V of G is the largest among $\langle \lambda, \alpha^\vee \rangle$, for λ a weight for the action of T on V , $\alpha > 0$.

This notion and this terminology go back to Dynkin [12, pages 331–332] where it is called “height” as in [14], while in Serre ([22] and [23]), it is simply “ $n(V)$ ”. If V is an irreducible representation, with dominant weight λ_+ and smallest weight λ_- , it is the sum of the coefficients of $\lambda_+ - \lambda_-$, expressed as linear combination of the simple roots.

It follows that the product in $\mathrm{End}(V)$ of the action of $\mathrm{ht}_G(V) + 1$ elements of $\mathrm{Lie}(U)$ vanishes and for ξ nilpotent in $\mathrm{Lie}(G)$, one has $\xi^{\mathrm{ht}_G(V)+1} = 0$ in $\mathrm{End}(V)$.

4.1

The representation $\rho : G \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}(V)$ is said to be of *low height* if $p > \mathrm{ht}_G(V)$. By [23, Theorem 6, page 25], representations of low height are semi-simple. One can show that if G admits a

representation V of low height which is almost faithful, meaning that its kernel is of multiplicative type, then G satisfies the assumption 2.1. That $p \geq h_G$ results from the more precise statement that $\text{ht}_G(V) \geq h_G - 1$ ([24, (5.2.4), page 213]). For the property that $\tilde{G} \rightarrow G'$ is étale, one uses the fact that the non-trivial irreducible representation of $\text{PGL}(p)$ of the smallest height is the adjoint representation which is of height $2p - 2$.

We now assume that V is of low height, and the assumption 2.1 holds for G . It follows that any nilpotent ξ in $\text{Lie}(G)$ satisfies $\xi^{[p]} = 0$, and further, the exponential map (5) is defined. The image $d\rho(\xi)$ of ξ in $\text{Lie}(\text{GL}(V)) = \text{End}(V)$ also has a vanishing p th-power, hence $\exp(d\rho(\xi) \cdot t)$ is defined.

4.2

Compatibility: If ξ in $\text{Lie}(G)$ is nilpotent

$$\rho(\exp(t\xi)) = \exp(t d\rho(\xi)). \quad (36)$$

As a consequence, if $u^{[p]} = 1$ in G , one has

$$\rho(u^t) = \rho(u)^t. \quad (37)$$

The following theorem is a schematic analogue of [8], for p large enough.

Theorem 4.5. *Suppose that the reductive group G admits a low height almost faithful representation $\rho : G \rightarrow \text{GL}(V)$, and that $p > h_G$. Then, for any non-trivial unipotent subgroup U of G , there exists a proper parabolic subgroup P of G containing the normalizer $N_G(U)$ of U , and whose unipotent radical contains U .*

The condition $p > h_G$ implies that G satisfies the assumption 2.1. If G is simple simply connected, it implies the existence of an almost faithful low height representation except for the G of type F_4 , E_6 , E_7 or E_8 , in which case the lowest height of a non-trivial representation and the Coxeter number are respectively $16 > 12$, $16 > 12$, $27 > 18$ and $58 > 30$. For these groups, we do not know whether the conclusion of the theorem is valid assuming only $p > h_G$.

Proof. Let V^U be the invariants of U acting on V . It is not zero, because U is unipotent. It is not V , because the representation V is almost faithful, hence faithful on U . It does not have a U -stable supplement V' in V , because U would have invariants in V' .

Let H be the subgroup scheme of G which stabilizes V^U . It contains the normalizer $N_G(U)$ of U . It is a doubly saturated subgroup scheme of G . Indeed, if h in $H(k)$ is of order p , by (37), $\rho(h^t) = \rho(h)^t = \sum_{i < p} \binom{t}{i} (\rho(h) - 1)^i$, which stabilizes V^U , and similarly if ξ in $\text{Lie}(H)$ is nilpotent, the $\exp(t\xi)$ are in H .

As $p > h_G$, Theorem 2.3 ensures that H_{red}^0 is a normal subgroup scheme of H and that the quotient H/H_{red}^0 is an extension of a finite group of order prime to p by a group of multiplicative type. It follows that $U \subset H_{\text{red}}^0$.

Lemma 4.6. H_{red}^0 is not reductive.

Proof. If it were, V would be a representation of low height of H_{red}^0 ([23, Corollary 1, page 25]), hence a semi-simple representation of H_{red}^0 , and V^U would have in V a H_{red}^0 -stable supplement. As V^U does not admit a supplement stable under $U \subset H_{\text{red}}^0$, this is absurd. $\square$

Proof of 4.5 continued: If S is a doubly saturated subgroup scheme of G , we will call $R_u(S_{\text{red}}^0)$ the unipotent radical of S and denote it simply by $R_u(S)$. By 2.3, it is a normal subgroup of S and $S/R_u(S^0)$ does not contain any normal unipotent subgroup. This justifies the terminology.

Define $U_1 := R_u(H)$. By 4.6, it is a non-trivial unipotent subgroup of G , and we can iterate the construction. We define for $i \geq 1$

$$\begin{aligned} H_i &:= \text{stabilizer of } V^{U_i} \\ U_{i+1} &:= R_u(H_i). \end{aligned}$$

One has $U_i \subset H_{i,\text{red}}^0$ and

$$U_i \subset N_G(U_i) \subset H_i \subset N_G(U_{i+1}) \subset H_{i+1} \subset \cdots \quad (38)$$

The H_i form an increasing sequence of smooth connected subgroups of G . It stabilizes, hence so do the sequences of the $U_{i,\text{red}}$ and of the H_i . If $H_i = H_{i+1}$, one has $H_i = N_G(U_{i+1}) = H_{i+1}$ and $U_{i+1} = R_u(H_i) = R_u(H_{i+1}) = R_u(N(U_{i+1})_{\text{red}}^\circ)$.

By [8, Proposition 2.3, page 99] (or for example [13, Section 30.3, Proposition on page 186]), this implies that $N(U_{i+1}) = (H_{i+1})_{\text{red}}$ is a proper parabolic subgroup of G . Call it Q . A parabolic subgroup of G is its own normalizer scheme (cf. [26, SGA3, XII, 7.9], [9, page 469]). As $(H_{i+1})_{\text{red}} = Q$ is normal in H_{i+1} , it follows that $H_{i+1} = Q$ and that $N_G(U) \subset Q$.

A Levi subgroup L of Q is a reductive subgroup of G , hence satisfies the assumptions of 4.5. It is isomorphic to $Q/R_u(Q)$. If U is not contained in $R_u(Q)$, we can repeat the argument for the image $\bar{U}$ of U in $Q/R_u(Q)$, which is isomorphic to L . One obtains a proper parabolic subgroup of $Q/R_u(Q)$ which contains the normalizer of $\bar{U}$. Its inverse image in Q is a parabolic subgroup, properly contained in Q and containing the normalizer of U . Iterating, one eventually finds a parabolic P containing $N_G(U)$ and such that $U \subset R_u(P)$. $\square$

Remark 4.7. Let $\tilde{G}$ be the simply connected central extension of the derived group G' , and let $\tilde{G}_i$ be its simple factors: $\tilde{G} = \prod \tilde{G}_i$. A representation of low height V of $\tilde{G}$ is almost faithful if and only if its restriction to each $\tilde{G}_i$ is not trivial. It suffices to check this for each $\tilde{G}_i$ separately. Thus we may assume $\tilde{G}$ is simply connected. The existence of a non-trivial V of low height implies that $p > 2$ for G of type B_n , C_n ($n \geq 2$) or F_4 and $p > 3$ for G of type G_2 . Let $\bar{G}$ be the image of $\tilde{G}$ in $\text{GL}(V)$.

If V is non-trivial, $u : \tilde{G} \rightarrow \bar{G}$ is an isogeny. We want to show that it is a central isogeny. If it is not, the structure of isogenies ([26, SGA3, XXII, 4.2.13]) shows that $\ker(u)$ contains the kernel of the Frobenius. The weights of V are the p th-powers and $\text{ht}_G(V)$ is a multiple of p , contradicting the low height assumption.

4.3

If G is a reductive group for which assumption 2.1 holds, and $\mathcal{G}$ is a subgroup scheme of G , the double saturation $\mathcal{G}^*$ of $\mathcal{G}$ is the smallest doubly saturated subgroup scheme of G containing $\mathcal{G}$. It is the intersection of the doubly saturated subgroup schemes containing $\mathcal{G}$, and is obtained from $\mathcal{G}$ by iterating the construction of taking the group generated by $\mathcal{G}$, the additive groups $\exp(t\xi)$ for ξ nilpotent in $\text{Lie}(\mathcal{G})$ and u^t for u of order p in $\mathcal{G}(k)$.

Corollary 4.8. *Let V be a low height almost faithful representation of a reductive group G . Assume that $p > h_G$. Let $\mathcal{G}$ be a subgroup scheme of G , and let $\mathcal{G}^*$ be its double saturation. Then the following conditions are equivalent:*

- (i) V is a semi-simple representation of $\mathcal{G}$
- (ii) V is a semi-simple representation of $\mathcal{G}^*$
- (iii) $\mathcal{G}$ is cr in G
- (iv) $\mathcal{G}^*$ is cr in G

(v) the unipotent radical of $(\mathcal{G}^*)_{\text{red}}^0$ is trivial.

Proof. (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii): If W is a subspace of V , the stabilizer in G of W is doubly saturated, as we saw in the beginning of the proof of 4.5. If $\mathcal{G}$ stabilizes W , it follows that $\mathcal{G}^*$ also stabilizes W : the lattice of sub-representations of V is the same for $\mathcal{G}$ and $\mathcal{G}^*$, hence the claim.

(iii) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iv): Similarly, the parabolic subgroups of G and their Levi subgroups are doubly saturated, hence contain $\mathcal{G}$ if and only if they contain $\mathcal{G}^*$.

not (v) $\Rightarrow$ not (ii): Let U be the unipotent radical of $(\mathcal{G}^*)_{\text{red}}^0$. If it is non-trivial, $V^U \neq V$, because V is faithful on U and does not have a U -stable supplement. As U is normal in $\mathcal{G}^*$ (2.3), V^U is a sub-representation for the action of $\mathcal{G}^*$ on V . This contradicts the semi-simplicity of V .

(v) $\Rightarrow$ (ii): The representation V of the reductive group $(\mathcal{G}^*)_{\text{red}}^0$ is of low height, hence semi-simple. By 2.3, $(\mathcal{G}^*)_{\text{red}}^0$ is a normal subgroup of $\mathcal{G}^*$ and the quotient A is linearly reductive. If W is a sub- $\mathcal{G}^*$ -representation of V , A acts on the affine space of $(\mathcal{G}^*)_{\text{red}}^0$ -invariant retractions $V \rightarrow W$. It has a fixed point, whose kernel is a supplement to W .

not (v) $\Rightarrow$ not (iv): Let U be the unipotent radical of $(\mathcal{G}^*)_{\text{red}}^0$. If it is not trivial, there exists a parabolic P containing its normalizer, hence $\mathcal{G}^*$, and the unipotent radical of P contains U (4.5). Thus, no Levi subgroup of P can contain $\mathcal{G}^*$.

(v) $\Rightarrow$ (iv): By [23, Theorem 7, page 26], $(\mathcal{G}^*)_{\text{red}}^0$ is cr in G , and one applies 4.2. $\square$

Corollary 4.9. *Let $\rho : G \rightarrow \text{GL}(V)$ be an almost faithful low height representation, and let v in V be an element such that the G -orbit of v in V is closed. Then there exists a connected multiplicative central subgroup scheme $M \subset G_v$ and a surjective homomorphism $M \times G_{v,\text{red}}^0 \rightarrow G_v^0$.*

Proof. The orbit being closed in V and hence affine, the reduced stabilizer $G_{v,\text{red}}$ is reductive ([6]). Since $p \geq h_G$ and since stabilizers are doubly saturated and 2.3(2) holds for $\mathcal{G} = G_v$, we get the required result. $\square$

We now observe that the results of [10, Section 6] can be obtained as a consequence of 4.8. Note that by the remarks in [10, page 607] it suffices to prove the semi-simplicity results in the case when k is algebraically closed.

Theorem 4.10. *Let G be an algebraic group. Let $(V_i)_{i \in I}$ be a finite family of semi-simple G -modules and let m_i be integers ≥ 0 . If*

$$\sum m_i(\dim V_i - m_i) < p \quad (39)$$

the G -module $\bigotimes_j \bigwedge^{m_j} V_j$ is semi-simple.

Proof. Let $G = \prod \text{GL}(V_j)$ and $V = \bigotimes \bigwedge^{m_j} V_j$. Then, (39) is simply the inequality $p > \text{ht}_G(V)$. Replacing G by its image in G we may and shall assume that G is a subgroup scheme of G . Since V_i are semi-simple G -modules, it follows that G is G -cr, for $G = \prod \text{GL}(V_j)$. By [10, §6.2], we may also assume that $p > \dim(V_j) = h_{\text{GL}(V_j)}$. Hence by working with the image of G (and G) in $\text{GL}(V)$ and applying 4.8, we conclude that V is semi-simple as a G -module. $\square$

Remark 4.11. If (V_i, q) is a non-degenerate quadratic space with $\dim V_i = 2d_i$ on which G acts by similitudes, then by passing to a subgroup of index at most 2 and mapping to the group of similitudes rather than $\text{GL}(V)$, one can replace the term $m_i(\dim V_i - m_i)$ by $m_i(\dim V_i - m_i - 1)$, when $m_i \leq 2d_i$.

Complete reducibility in the classical case

By 4.1, a subgroup scheme $\mathcal{G} \subset G$ is called cr if for every parabolic subgroup $P \supset G$ containing G , there exists an opposite parabolic subgroup P' such that $G \subset P \cap P'$. Suppose that $\text{char}(k) \neq 2$ and let G be $\text{SO}(V)$ (or $\text{Sp}(V)$ in any characteristic), relative to a non-degenerate symmetric or alternating bilinear form B on V . In this situation, the notion of cr can be interpreted as follows: $\mathcal{G}$ is cr in G if and only if for every $\mathcal{G}$ -submodule $W \subset V$ which is totally isotropic, there exists a totally isotropic $\mathcal{G}$ -submodule W' of the same dimension, such that the restriction of B to $W + W'$ is non-degenerate (cf. [24, Example 3.3.3, page 206]).

Lemma 4.12. *Let the subgroup scheme $\mathcal{G}$ of G be cr. Then the $\mathcal{G}$ -module V is semi-simple and conversely.*

Proof. Let $W \subset V$ be a $\mathcal{G}$ -submodule. Then we need to produce a $\mathcal{G}$ -complement.

Consider $W_1 := W \cap W^\perp$. If $W_1 = (0)$, then $W \oplus W^\perp = V$ and we are done. So let $W_1 \neq (0)$. Then W_1 is a $\mathcal{G}$ -submodule which is totally isotropic and hence by the cr property, we have a totally isotropic $\mathcal{G}$ -submodule W_{10} of the same dimension as W_1 , such that the form B is non-degenerate on $W_1 + W_{10}$.

In particular, $W_1 \cap W_{10} = (0)$. Since $W_1 \subset W^\perp$, we see that $W \subset W_1^\perp$.

Let $w \in W_2 := W \cap W_{10}^\perp \cap W_1^\perp \cap W_{10}$ and suppose $w \neq 0$. Since $w \in W_{10}$, there exists $w' \in W_1$ such that $B(w, w') \neq 0$. On the other hand, since $w \in W_2 \subset W_1^\perp$, $B(w, v) = 0$ for all $v \in W$ and in particular $B(w, w') \neq 0$ which contradicts the assumption that $w \neq 0$. Hence it follows that $W \cap W_{10} = (0)$.

Thus, $W \oplus W_{10} \subset V$ is a $\mathcal{G}$ -submodule. We proceed similarly and get $X_1 = X \cap X^\perp$ such that $X \oplus X_{10} \subset V$. If $X_1 = (0)$, then $V = X \oplus X^\perp$, so get a $\mathcal{G}$ -decomposition of V as $W \oplus W_{10} \oplus \cdots$, that is a $\mathcal{G}$ -complement of W .

Conversely, let V be semi-simple as a $\mathcal{G}$ -module. Let $W \subset V$ be a totally isotropic $\mathcal{G}$ -submodule of $\dim(W) = d$. Note that $d < \dim(V)/2$. We therefore have a $\mathcal{G}$ -submodule $Z \subset V$ such $V = W \oplus Z$. The non-degenerate form B gives a $\mathcal{G}$ -equivariant isomorphism $\varphi : V \xrightarrow{\sim} V^* = W^* \oplus Z^*$ and since W is totally isotropic $\varphi(W) \cap W^* = (0)$. Hence $\varphi(W) \subset Z$.

Again, since W is totally isotropic, the restriction of B to Z is non-degenerate and hence we get an isomorphism $\psi : Z^* \xrightarrow{\sim} Z$. Define $W^0 := \psi(\varphi(W))$.

Then it is easily seen that W^0 is of dimension d and also totally isotropic $\mathcal{G}$ -invariant submodule of V . Finally, B is non-degenerate on $W \oplus W^0$. Hence $\mathcal{G}$ is cr in G . $\square$

5 Étale slices in positive characteristics

Let G act on an affine variety X and let x be a point of X whose orbit $G \cdot x$ is closed in X . We prove a schematic analogue of Luna's étale slice theorem (5.1, 5.6) for suitable bounds on the characteristic p . In order to make this precise, one needs to extend the notion of a slice in [2, Definition 7.1] to a scheme theoretic setting (see 5.6) and in the process one has to work with schematic stabilizers of closed orbits. The key issue then becomes the semi-simplicity of the tangent space to x in X as a representation of the stabilizer of G at x . Here the structure theorem 2.3 become crucial and the bounds on p are forced as a consequence. In [2] the scheme-theoretic aspects are eschewed forcing them to make the assumption that the orbit $G \cdot x$ is "separable", i.e. the stabilizer G_x is reduced. The bounds on the characteristic therefore do not show up in [2].

We begin this section with the following (linear) analogue of the Luna étale slice theorem in positive characteristics.

Theorem 5.1. *Let V be a G -module with low height i.e. such that $p > \text{ht}_G(V)$. Let v in V be an element such that the orbit $G \cdot v$ is a closed orbit in V . Then there exists a G_v -invariant*

linear subspace S of V giving rise to a commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} G \times^{G_v} S & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & V \\ f \downarrow & & \downarrow q \\ (G \times^{G_v} S) // G & \xrightarrow{\ell} & V // G \end{array} \quad (40)$$

and G -equivariant open subsets $U \subset (G \times^{G_v} S)$ containing the closed orbit $G \cdot v$ and an open subset U_0 of V containing v , for which (40) induces a cartesian diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & U_0 \\ f|_U \downarrow & & \downarrow q|_{U_0} \\ U // G & \xrightarrow{\ell|_U} & U_0 // G \end{array} \quad (41)$$

such that the morphism $\ell|_U$ is étale.

Remark 5.2. The above theorem was stated in the note [18] whose proof contained serious gaps (as was pointed to the authors by Serre in a private correspondence).

We note that G/G_v is constructed in [11, III, Proposition 3.5.2]. It represents the quotient in the category of fppf sheaves. Furthermore if $\rho_v : G \rightarrow V$; $g \mapsto g \cdot v$, the image $\text{im}(\rho_v)$, as a locally closed sub-scheme of V with its reduced scheme structure, can be identified with the scheme G/G_v . We call this locally closed sub-scheme, the orbit $G \cdot v$ and have the identification $G/G_v \simeq G \cdot v$ (see also [11, Proposition and Definition 1.6, III, §3, page 325]).

Proposition 5.3. *Let V be an arbitrary G -module. Let $v \in V$ and suppose that there exists a G_v -submodule S of the tangent space $T_v(V)$, such that $T_v(V)$ splits as $T_v(G \cdot v) \oplus S$. Let G act on $G \times S$ by $h : (g, s) \mapsto (hg, s)$. Then the G -morphism $\Phi : G \times S \rightarrow V$ given by $(g, s) \mapsto g \cdot v + g \cdot s$ descends to a G -morphism*

$$\varphi : G \times^{G_v} S \rightarrow V \quad (42)$$

which is étale at $(e, 0)$, e being the identity of G .

Proof. To ensure that Φ descends to a morphism φ , we need to check for every commutative k -algebra A , that Φ is constant on all $G_v(A)$ -orbits. For simplicity of exposition we will suppress the A .

Let γ in G_v act on $G \times S$ by $\gamma : (g, s) \mapsto (g \cdot \gamma, \gamma^{-1} \cdot s)$. Observe that $\Phi \circ \gamma : (g, s) \mapsto \Phi(g \cdot \gamma, \gamma^{-1} \cdot s) = g \cdot \gamma \cdot v + g \cdot \gamma \cdot \gamma^{-1} \cdot s = g \cdot v + g \cdot s$ (since γ fixes v). Therefore it is constant on the G_v -orbits. Since the action of G_v on $G \times S$ is scheme-theoretically free, Φ descends to a morphism $\varphi : G \times^{G_v} S \rightarrow V$.

Clearly the actions of G and G_v on $G \times S$ commute and hence the descended morphism is also a G -morphism.

Observe that the quotient morphism $G \rightarrow G/G_v$ is a torsor for the group scheme G_v , locally trivial under the fppf topology. Since the action of G_v on S is linear, we see that the associated fibre space $G \times^{G_v} S \rightarrow G/G_v$ is a locally free sheaf of rank $= \dim(S)$. In particular, $G \times^{G_v} S$ is a smooth k -scheme of finite type. Observe further that under the morphism φ , the zero section of the vector bundle $\pi : G \times^{G_v} S \rightarrow G/G_v$ canonically maps onto the orbit $G \cdot v \subset V$, while the fibre $\pi^{-1}(e \cdot G_v)$ of the identity coset $e \cdot G_v : G/G_v$ maps isomorphically to the affine subspace $S + v \subset V$.

Since $T_v(V) = T_v(G \cdot v) \oplus S$ by assumption, it follows that the differential $d\varphi_z$, at $z = (e, 0)$, is an isomorphism.

We now apply [10, Lemme 2.9], to conclude that the morphism $\varphi : G \times^{G_v} S \rightarrow V$ is étale at $z = (e, 0)$. $\square$

Proposition 5.4. *Let V be a G -module such that $p > \text{ht}_G(V)$, and let v in V be an element such that the G -orbit of v in V is closed. Then there exists a G_v -submodule $S \subset V$ such that $V = T_v(G \cdot v) \oplus S$ as a G_v -module. In particular, the consequences of 5.3 hold.*

Proof. One knows that G_v^0 is the kernel of the natural map $G_v \rightarrow \pi_0(G_v)$, to the group of connected components, and hence is a normal subgroup of finite index. Further, we note that $G_v = G_v^0 = G_{v,\text{red}} \cdot |G_v/G_v^0|$. Note also that since G_v is a saturated subgroup of G , by [23, page 23, Property 3] the index $|G_v/G_{v,\text{red}}^0|$ is prime to p .

Since $G \cdot v$ is a closed orbit by 4.9 (and 2.3) we have an exact sequence:

$$1 \rightarrow G_{v,\text{red}}^0 \rightarrow G_v^0 \rightarrow Q \rightarrow 1 \quad (43)$$

where Q is a multiplicative group scheme.

Now V is semi-simple as a $G_{v,\text{red}}^0$ -module, $G_{v,\text{red}}^0$ being a saturated subgroup of G and also as a Q -module since it is multiplicative (and hence linearly reductive). Thus by [10, Lemme 4.2] V is semi-simple as a G_v^0 -module and therefore as a G_v -module as well.

In particular, we have a G_v -supplement S for the G_v -invariant subspace $T_v(G \cdot v) \subset T_v(V) = V$, i.e. we have a G_v -decomposition $S \oplus T_v(G \cdot v)$ for V . $\square$

We recall the “Fundamental lemma of Luna” which holds in positive characteristics as well and which is essential to complete the proof of Theorem 5.1.

Lemma 5.5 ([20, page 152]). *Let $\bar{s} : X \rightarrow Y$ be a G -morphism of affine G -schemes. Let $F \subset X$ be a closed orbit such that:*

1. $\bar{s}$ is étale at some point of F
2. $\bar{s}(F)$ is closed in Y
3. $\bar{s}$ is injective on F
4. X is normal along F .

Then there are affine G -invariant open subsets $U \subset X$ and $U_0 \subset Y$ with $F \subset U$ such that $\bar{s} : U \rightarrow U_0$ is étale and $(\bar{s}, p_U) : U \rightarrow U_0 \times_{U_0//G} U//G$ is an isomorphism (where $p_U : U \rightarrow U//G$ is the quotient morphism).

Proof of 5.1. As a first step, we need to show that the categorical quotient $G \times^{G_v} S//G$ exists as a scheme. As we have seen in 5.3, action of G on $G \times S$ (via $g : (a, s) = (ga, s)$) and the (twisted) action of G_v on $G \times S$ commute and hence

$$k[G \times^{G_v} S]^G = (k[G \times S]^{G_v})^G = (k[G \times S]^G)^{G_v} = k[S]^{G_v}. \quad (44)$$

Thus it is enough to show that $k[S]^{G_v}$ is finitely generated and we would have

$$G \times^{G_v} S//G \simeq S//G_v. \quad (45)$$

As we have observed in the proof of 5.4, $G_v^0 \subset G_v$ is a normal subgroup of finite index. Thus, the finite generation of $k[S]^{G_v}$ is reduced to checking finite generation of $k[S]^{G_v^0}$. We may therefore replace G_v by G_v^0 in the proof. Further, since $G \cdot v$ is a closed orbit, $G_{v,\text{red}}$ is reductive. Therefore, by 4.9, we have a surjection $M \times G_{v,\text{red}} \rightarrow G_v^0$. Since M in G_v is central $k[S]^{G_v^0} = k[S]^{M \times G_{v,\text{red}}}$.

Again, since $G_{v,\text{red}}$ is reductive, the ring of invariants $k[S]^{G_{v,\text{red}}}$ is a finitely generated k -algebra. Since M is a group of multiplicative type over an algebraically closed field, it is a product of $\mathbb{G}_m$'s and a finite group scheme. Therefore, by [20, Theorem 1.1] and [19, Page 113], the ring of invariants $k[S]^{M \times G_{v,\text{red}}}$ is also finitely generated. This proves the finite generation of $k[S]^{G_v}$.

The commutativity of the diagram (40) now follows by the property of categorical quotients by the group G .

Now we check the conditions of Lemma 5.5. We consider the given closed G -orbit $F = G \times^{G_v} \{v\}$. Then we need to check that $\varphi(F)$ is a closed orbit in V . In fact, $\varphi(F)$ is precisely the closed orbit $G \cdot \varphi(v) = G \cdot v \subset V$. Thus we have verified conditions (2) and (3) of Lemma 5.5. Condition (1) is precisely the content of 5.4 and (4) holds since $G \times^{G_v} S$ has been seen to be smooth.

The isomorphism $(\bar{s}, p_U)$ shows that the diagram (41) is cartesian. This completes the proof of 5.1.

Corollary 5.6. *Let X be an affine G -scheme embeddable as a closed G -subscheme in low height G -module. Let $x \in X$ be such that the orbit $G \cdot x \subset X$ is closed. Then there exists a locally closed G_x -invariant subscheme (a “slice”) X_1 , of X with $x \in X_1$ such that the conclusions of 5.1 hold for the G -morphism $G \times^{G_x} X_1 \rightarrow X$.*

Proof. This follows from 5.1 (which corresponds to [2, Proposition 7.4]) exactly as in [2, Proposition 7.6]. $\square$

The following consequence of the slice theorem has many applications so we state it here without proof.

Corollary 5.7 ((see [2, Proposition 8.5, page 312])). *Let F be an affine G -subvariety of $\mathbb{P}(V)$, with V as a G -module with low height, and suppose that F contains a unique closed orbit F_{cl} . Then there exists a G -retract $F \rightarrow F_{cl}$.*

Let V be a finite dimensional G -module and let

$$\mathrm{ht}_G(\hat{\mathfrak{g}}(V)) := \max_i \mathrm{ht}_G(\wedge^i(V)) \quad (46)$$

We then have the following application to the theory of semistable principal bundles in positive characteristics.

Theorem 5.8. *Let E be a stable G -bundle with G semi-simple and $\rho : G \rightarrow \mathrm{SL}(V)$ be a representation such that $p > \mathrm{ht}_G(\hat{\mathfrak{g}}(V))$. Then the associated bundle $E(V)$ is polystable of degree 0.*

Proof. The proof follows [1, Theorem 9.11] verbatim where the notion of “separable index” is replaced by the Dynkin height, the key ingredient being Corollary 5.7. $\square$

Acknowledgments. The first author thanks Gopal Prasad for his detailed comments on an earlier manuscript. He also thanks Brian Conrad for helpful discussions and sharing many insights and Michel Brion for his detailed comments and suggestions on an earlier manuscript. We thank the referee for his careful reading of the paper and for his comments and questions.

6 Added in proof

In Section 2.2, after making suitable assumptions on G , we refer to Serre in (5) for the construction of the exponential map $\exp : \mathfrak{g}_{\mathrm{nilp}} \xrightarrow{\sim} G^u$. The proof that Serre gives in ([23, Theorem 3, page 21]) is only a sketch. At his suggestion, we complete it. We work in principle over an algebraically closed field but phrase the argument so that it remains valid over more general bases.

Let T be a maximal torus, B a Borel subgroup containing T and U its unipotent radical. We assume $p \geq h$. By this assumption on the characteristic, the Campbell-Hausdorff group law on $\mathrm{Lie}(U)$ is well-defined. The first step is the construction of a B -equivariant isomorphism

$$\exp : (\mathrm{Lie}(U), \cdot) \xrightarrow{\sim} U \quad (47)$$

For this step we give complete proofs. The second step is to glue these isomorphisms into

$$\exp : \mathfrak{g}_{\text{nilp}} \xrightarrow{\sim} G^u. \quad (48)$$

This requires the additional assumption that the simply connected covering $\tilde{G}$ of the derived group G' is étale over G' . Here we will mainly give references.

6.1

Let R^+ be the set of positive roots: the set of roots of T acting on $\text{Lie}(U)$. For α in R^+ , let U_α be the corresponding root subgroup, and let x_α be an isomorphism from U_α to $\mathbb{G}_a$.

Fix a total order on R^+ . The corresponding product map from $\prod_\alpha U_\alpha$ to U is an isomorphism of schemes: it is a morphism between smooth connected schemes which is étale at the origin, bijective by [5, 13-05], and one applies Zariski's main theorem as in [26, SGA3, XXII, 4.1] (or see [7, IV, 14.5]).

This isomorphism identifies U with the affine space with coordinates (x_α) ($\alpha \in R^+$). In these coordinates, the action of T on U by conjugation is given by

$$t \in T \text{ acts by } (x_\alpha) \mapsto (\alpha(t)x_\alpha)$$

This action respects the group law. It follows that the α -coordinate of $x \cdot y$ is a linear combination of the $x_\beta^i y_\gamma^j$ for $i\beta + j\gamma = \alpha$.

We grade the polynomial algebra $\mathcal{O}(U)$ by defining degree of x_α to be the height of α (if the expression of α as a linear combination of simple roots is $\sum n_i \alpha_i$, the height of α is $\sum n_i$). The corresponding increasing filtration $\text{Fil}_\bullet$ of $\mathcal{O}(U)$ is invariant by T -conjugation as well as by the action on the right and left by U -translations. It is hence invariant by B -conjugation.

The assumption $p \geq h$ is equivalent to $\mathcal{O}(U)$ being generated by Fil_{p-1} . The definition of the exponential (47) is a special case of the following construction.

6.2

Let U be an algebraic group and $\text{Fil}_\bullet$ be an increasing filtration of its affine algebra. Assume that $\mathcal{O}(U)$ is a polynomial algebra $k[(x_\alpha)_\alpha]$ and that for some integers $d(\alpha) > 0$, $\text{Fil}_\bullet$ is the increasing filtration deduced from the grading for which x_α is homogeneous of degree $d(\alpha)$. Assume that the α -coordinate of $x \cdot y$ is a polynomial of degree $\leq d(\alpha)$ in the (weighted) coordinate of x and y . This is equivalent to the compatibility:

$$\Delta(\text{Fil}_i) \subset \sum_{j+k=i} \text{Fil}_j \otimes \text{Fil}_k \quad (49)$$

of the filtration $\text{Fil}_\bullet$ with the coproduct.

We will view $\text{Lie}(U)$ as the Lie algebra of the left invariant vector fields on U . Let D_α be the element of $\text{Lie}(U)$ which is x_α at e . If $[\epsilon]$ is the $k[\epsilon]/((\epsilon)^2)$ valued point of U with coordinate $x_\alpha = \epsilon$, $x_\beta = 0$ for $\beta \neq \alpha$, $D_\alpha f$ is the coefficient of ϵ in $f(x \cdot [\epsilon])$. From this it follows that $D_\alpha(x_\beta)$ is of degree $\leq d(\beta) - d(\alpha)$, and as a consequence

$$D_\alpha \text{Fil}_i \subset \text{Fil}_{i-d(\alpha)} \quad (50)$$

i.e. D_α is of (descending) filtration $d(\alpha)$.

We now assume that $\mathcal{O}(U)$ is generated by Fil_{p-1} , i.e. that all $d(\alpha)$ are less than p . Then any Lie polynomial of degree $\geq p$ in the derivations $D_\alpha \in \text{Lie}(U)$ vanishes on the x_α and hence vanishes identically, implying that the Campbell-Hausdorff group law on $\text{Lie}(U)$ is defined.

Definition 6.1. The exponential map $\exp$ from $\text{Lie}(U)$ to U is the map having as coordinates the truncated exponential

$$\exp(D)_\alpha := \sum_{n < p} \frac{D^n}{n!}(x_\alpha) \text{ at } e \quad (51)$$

Lemma 6.2. *For f in Fil_{p-1} , one has*

$$f(\exp(D)) = \sum_{n < p} \frac{D^n}{n!}(f) \text{ at } e \quad (52)$$

Proof. This holds by the definition of $\exp$ when f is a coordinate function x_α , and it suffices to check that, for g in Fil_a and h in Fil_b with $a + b < p$, one has the following equality:

$$\frac{D^n}{n!}(fg) = \sum \frac{D^n}{n!}(f) \frac{D^n}{n!}(g) \quad (53)$$

the sums being truncated at $n < p$. Both sides can be identified with sums $\frac{D^n}{n!}(f) \frac{D^m}{m!}(g)$, where on the left we have $n + m < p$ and on the right $n < p$ and $m < p$. If $n + m \geq p$, then either $n > a$ or $m > b$, in which case $D^n(f) = 0$ (resp. $D^m(g) = 0$). The terms missing on the left side therefore vanish. $\square$

Lemma 6.3. *The morphism $\exp$ is a group homomorphism*

$$\exp : (\text{Lie}(U), \cdot) \rightarrow U. \quad (54)$$

Proof. If f is in Fil_{p-1} , so are its left-translates. As the derivations D_α in $\text{Lie}(U)$ are left invariant, (52) applied to the left-translate of f gives:

$$f(x \cdot \exp(D)) = \sum_{n < p} \frac{D^n}{n!}(f) \text{ at } x \quad (55)$$

hence

$$f(\exp(D') \cdot \exp(D)) = \sum_{n, m < p} \frac{D'^m}{m!} \frac{D^n}{n!}(f) \text{ at } e \quad (56)$$

In the completed free associative algebra $\mathbb{Q}\langle\langle X, Y \rangle\rangle$, if $H_d(X, Y)$ is the Lie polynomial which is the degree d component of the Campbell-Hausdorff group law, one has

$$\exp\left(\sum_d H_d(X, Y)\right) = \exp(X) \cdot \exp(Y). \quad (57)$$

Modulo terms of degree $\geq p$, one still has

$$\sum_{n \leq p} \frac{H_n(X, Y)}{n!} = \sum_{n < p} \frac{X^n}{n!} \cdot \sum_{n < p} \frac{Y^n}{n!} \quad (58)$$

and this continues to hold in $\mathbb{Z}[\frac{1}{(p-1)!}]\langle\langle X, Y \rangle\rangle$. Substituting D' and D for X and Y , we get

$$f(\exp(D') \cdot \exp(D)) = f(\exp(D' \cdot D)) \quad (59)$$

for f in Fil_{p-1} . Hence $\exp(D') \cdot \exp(D) = \exp(D' \cdot D)$. For f in Fil_{p-1} , (55) reads

$$\frac{D^n}{n!}f = \sum_{0 < n < p} \frac{D^n}{n!}(f) \text{ at } \exp(D) \quad (60)$$

In $\mathbb{Q}[[X]]$, one has $\log \exp(X) = X$. Modulo monomials of degree $\geq p$, one still has

$$\sum_{0 < n < p} \frac{(-1)^n}{n} \left(\sum_{0 < m < p} \frac{X^m}{m!} \right)^n = X \quad (61)$$

and this continues to hold in $\mathbb{Z}[\frac{1}{(p-1)!}][[X]]$.

Substituting D for X , in (61), we obtain from (60) that for f in Fil_{p-1} , one has

$$Df = \sum_{0 < n < p} (-1)^n \frac{(\log \Delta)^n}{n} f \quad (62)$$

This gives a formula for a left inverse $\log \Delta$ of $\exp : \text{Lie}(U) \rightarrow U$; viewed as a derivation,

$$\log \Delta = \sum_{n < p} (-1)^n \frac{\Delta^n}{n} \quad (63)$$

when applied to f in Fil_{p-1} . This shows that the exponential is injective and hence, being an étale homomorphism of connected groups, it is an isomorphism.

In the case of the unipotent radical U of a Borel subgroup, the given construction of the exponential map, depending only on the filtration $\text{Fil}_\bullet$ of $\mathcal{O}(U)$, is invariant by B -conjugation. $\square$

Remark 6.4.

- (i) Let $I \subset R^+$ be the set of simple roots, and for $J \subset I$, let P_J be the corresponding parabolics subgroup and U_J its unipotent radical. Let $R_J^+ \subset R^+$ be the set of $\alpha \in R^+$ which are linear combinations of simple roots in J . For $\alpha = \sum n_i \alpha_i$ in $R^+ \setminus R_J^+$, define $d_J(\alpha) = \sum_{i \notin J} n_i$. Then if all $d_J(\alpha)$ are $< p$, the construction we have given of the exponential map gives a similar map

$$\exp : \text{Lie}(U_J) \xrightarrow{\sim} U_J. \quad (64)$$

It suffices to replace d by d_J in the earlier proofs.

- (ii) More generally, let $\Gamma \subset R^+$ be a closed set of positive roots, and let U_Γ be the corresponding subgroup of U . For any fixed total order on Γ , the corresponding product map

$$\prod_{\alpha \in \Gamma} U_\alpha \xrightarrow{\sim} U_\Gamma \quad (65)$$

is an isomorphism of schemes. For α in Γ , define $d_\Gamma(\alpha)$ to be the largest number of elements of Γ of which α is the sum (with repetitions allowed).

In [21], Seitz states that when all $d_\Gamma(\alpha)$ are $< p$, an exponential map from $\text{Lie}(U_\Gamma)$ to U_Γ is defined. He writes (before [21, Proposition 5.1, page 483]) that the argument in Section 4 of [22] yields this result. The reference is mistaken and should be replaced by Section 2.1 of [25]. The argument given in the preceding paragraphs, with d replaced by d_Γ , also yields the result.

6.3

Let $\mathcal{B}$ be the variety of Borel subgroups of G . We have fiber spaces $X_{\mathcal{B}}$ and $Y_{\mathcal{B}}$ over $\mathcal{B}$ where the fibers at a Borel subgroup B in $\mathcal{B}$ are respectively the unipotent radical U and its Lie algebra.

The given construction of the exponential map works over any base on which the primes $\ell < h$ are invertible. Over $\mathcal{B}$, we therefore obtain an isomorphism $\exp : Y_{\mathcal{B}} \xrightarrow{\sim} X_{\mathcal{B}}$. The natural map from $X_{\mathcal{B}}$ to G (resp. $Y_{\mathcal{B}}$ to $\text{Lie}(G)$) is proper, being the restriction to a closed subset of $\mathcal{B} \times G$ (resp. $\mathcal{B} \times \text{Lie}(G)$) of the second projection.

The reduced subscheme $\mathfrak{g}_{\text{nilp}}$ (resp. G^u) of $\text{Lie}(G)$ (resp. G) with points the nilpotent (resp. unipotent) elements, is the schematic image of $Y_{\mathcal{B}}$ in $\text{Lie}(G)$ (resp. of $X_{\mathcal{B}}$ in G). We want to complete the following G -equivariant diagram in the solid arrows by an isomorphism at the dotted arrow:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Y_{\mathcal{B}} & \xrightarrow[\sim]{\exp} & X_{\mathcal{B}} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathfrak{g}_{\text{nilp}} & \cdots \cdots \cdots & G^u \end{array} \quad (66)$$

Replacing G by its derived group G' does not change the diagram, nor does replacing a semi-simple G by its simply connected covering $\tilde{G}$, provided $\tilde{G}$ is étale over G . Under our assumptions this reduces us to the case where G is semi-simple and simply connected. Here are references for the existence of the dotted arrow isomorphism in (66).

- (A) By [27, 6.11, 8.1] G^u is normal with a smooth dense orbit whose complement is of codimension ≥ 2 . This holds in any characteristic for any simply connected G . Normality results from G^u being the complete intersection in G defined by the equations $\chi(g) = \chi(e)$ for χ the characters of the fundamental representations, and being smooth outside codimension 2.
- (B) The same holds for $\mathfrak{g}_{\text{nilp}}$ when G is simply connected and p good, because $\mathfrak{g}_{\text{nilp}}$ is then equivariantly isomorphic to G^u . A nice proof is in [2, Corollary 9.3.4]. The isomorphism uses a representation (V, ρ) such that the pairing $\text{Tr}(\rho(X)\rho(Y))$ on $\text{Lie}(G)$ is non-degenerate. It is then defined as induced by the map $g \mapsto \rho(g) - 1$ from G to $\text{End}(V)$, composed with the orthogonal projection of $\text{End}(V)$ (endowed with the symmetric bilinear form $\text{Tr}(XY)$) to $\text{Lie}(G) \subset \text{End } V$. This does not work for $\text{SL}(n)$ for which one uses $X \mapsto 1 + X$.
- (C) Over the dense orbits of $\mathfrak{g}_{\text{nilp}}$ and G^u , (66) is a system of isomorphisms, and the composite isomorphism extends across codimension 2 by normality.

A Coxeter number and root systems, by Zhiwei Yun

Proposition 1. Let R be an irreducible root system associated to a simple group G with Coxeter number h and let X be the lattice spanned by R . Let $\varphi : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ be a homomorphism. Then there exists a basis B for R such that if $\alpha \in R$ satisfies $\varphi(\alpha) \in [0, 1/h) \bmod \mathbb{Z}$, then α is positive with respect to B .

Proof. Pick any basis $B_0 = \{\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_r\}$ of R . We lift φ to a linear map $y : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ which is viewed as a point in $V = \text{Hom}(X, \mathbb{R})$.

Let W be the Weyl group of R . Then there is an action of the extended Weyl group $\text{Hom}(X, \mathbb{Z}) \rtimes W$ on V and the validity of the statement for the linear map y is invariant for this action. Therefore we may assume that y lies in the fundamental alcove attached to B_0 , i.e.

$$\alpha_j(y) \geq 0, \quad 1 \leq j \leq r \quad (67)$$

$$\tilde{\alpha}(y) \leq 1 \quad (68)$$

where $\tilde{\alpha}$ is the highest root with respect to B_0 . Then for all $\alpha \in R$, we have

$$|\alpha(y)| \leq 1. \quad (69)$$

We claim that there exists a basis B of R such that for any $\beta \in R$ with

$$|\beta(y)| \in [1/2, 1/2 + 1/h) \setminus [0, 1/h) \bmod \mathbb{Z}, \quad (70)$$

β is positive with respect to B .

Write $\tilde{\alpha} = \sum_{i=0}^r n_i \alpha_i$ and let $\alpha_0 = -\tilde{\alpha}$ and $n_0 = 1$ as usual. Then we have the equality $\sum_{i=0}^r n_i \alpha_i = 0$, viewed as affine functions on V and we have

$$h = \sum_{i=0}^r n_i. \quad (71)$$

Therefore, for some $0 \leq i_0 \leq r$, we have $\alpha_{i_0}(y) \geq 1/h$.

If $i_0 = 0$, then $\tilde{\alpha}(y) \leq 1 - 1/h$ and in this case, we can take $B = B_0$. In fact, for any negative root β with respect to B_0 , we have $0 \geq \beta(y) \geq -1 + 1/h$, so that β cannot satisfy the condition (70).

If $i_0 > 0$, let v_{i_0} be the vertex of the fundamental alcove opposite to the root hyperplane α_{i_0} . So $\alpha_j(v_{i_0}) = 0$ if $j \neq i_0$ and $\alpha_{i_0}(v_{i_0}) = 1 = n_{i_0}$. We take a basis B of R such that the vector $y - v_{i_0}$ is dominant, i.e. for any $\beta \in R$ positive for B , we have the relation: $\beta(y) \geq \beta(v_{i_0})$.

Such a basis B of R satisfies the requirements of the claim. In fact, let $\beta \in R$ be negative with respect to B .

Write $\beta = \sum_{j=1}^r m_j \alpha_j$ for some m_j . Then, $\beta(v_{i_0}) = m_{i_0}/n_{i_0}$. On the other hand, $\beta(y) = \sum_{j=1}^r m_j \alpha_j(y)$. Since β is negative for B , we have

$$\beta(y) \leq \beta(v_{i_0}) = m_{i_0}/n_{i_0} \quad (72)$$

and we have two cases:

- If $\beta > 0$, with respect to B_0 , then $\beta(y) \geq 0$ and $0 \leq m_j \leq n_j$ for all j . If $m_{i_0} = 0$, then (72) implies that $\beta(y) = 0$ and so β fails to satisfy (70). If $m_{i_0} \geq 1$, then $\beta(y) \geq \alpha_{i_0}(y) \geq 1/h$, again not satisfying (70).
- If $\beta < 0$, with respect to B_0 , then $-1 \leq \beta(y) \leq 0$ and $-n_j \leq m_j \leq 0$ for all j . If $m_{i_0} = n_{i_0}$, then $\beta(v_{i_0}) = -1$ which forces $\beta(y) = -1$ by (72). If $m_{i_0} \leq n_{i_0} - 1$, then comparing $\beta(y)$ with $\tilde{\alpha}(y)$, it misses at least one copy of $\alpha_{i_0}(y)$, therefore $\beta(y) \leq \tilde{\alpha}(y) - \alpha_{i_0}(y) \leq 1 - 1/h$ and yet again, $\beta(y)$ does not satisfy (70).

This proves the claim and the proposition. □

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